

Shared evidence • Museum records

The evidence museum

Name _____ Date _____

Fictional records for review. Use the history and observations, not just an object's name.

A • Ancient shell

A geologist identifies a preserved shell in old sedimentary rock. Its original colour is unknown.

C • Soil sample

Observed: mineral grains, dark decayed leaf fragments and spaces. Some spaces contain water or air.

E • Complete darkness

Same fossil, but all light is excluded. The eye receives no light from it.

B • Model imprint

A pupil pressed a modern shell into clay today. It models an imprint; it is not an ancient fossil.

D • Lit display

A lamp lights the fossil. Some reflected light enters a visitor's eye.

W1. Which record is an ancient fossil, and which is a model? Why?

W2. Repair “soil is only rock” or “eyes make viewing light”.

Route 1 • Correct the labels

Word bank: ancient / model / mixture / reflected light.

S1. Which is the ancient fossil?

A. A

B. B

S2. Name two different things recorded in soil C.

S3. Where does light go to make the exhibit visible?

A. Into the eye

B. Out of the eye

S4. Finish one accurate museum label: "This evidence shows..."

Route 2 • Produce the exhibit guide

Use A-E. Make each reason traceable to a card.

M1. Explain why A and B need different labels.

M2. Write an accurate soil label with two components.

M3. Draw or describe the light path for D. Include the eye.

M4. What does A not tell us about the original shell?

Route 3 • Challenge a confident claim

An editor writes: “Every stone is a fossil. We know this shell’s exact colour. The dark exhibit disappeared.”

T1. Correct the first claim. What evidence of life is needed?

T2. Can card A establish the shell’s exact colour? Explain.

T3. Explain the difference between “not visible” and “not present” using E.

T4. A fresh leaf falls into soil. Explain why this alone does not make it a fossil.

Exit and reflection

Point, draw, write or tell an adult.

E1. What does a fossil preserve?

E2. Name one non-mineral part of soil.

E3. What must enter the eye to see the exhibit?

R1. Which idea did you improve or defend? What evidence helped?

R2. What useful question would you investigate next?
